banker from Netherlands who after accepting the offer changed his mind. Then an Italian was selected but the British shareholders were not happy with him. Finally a Canadian banker was selected but his parent bank was unable to spare his services. Mehta, who was kept abreast of these developments, thought there was no reason to have a foreigner for the post.

Mehta had heard high praise of Parekh from various quarters and felt that he would fit the bill very well. He told Woods not to look for an expatriate and conveyed to him that if the Board was reorganized and Parekh was appointed General Manager, he was prepared to become Chairman provided the Board, the shareholders, and the Government of India agreed. Black and Woods came to Delhi for the World Bank and Fund Meetings in October, 1958, and had discussions with some of the Directors of ICICI as well as with the Finance Minister, the RBI Governor and the Finance Secretary in this connection. It was agreed that some of the senior Directors would retire and be replaced with younger men while a few might remain for the sake of continuity. This arrangement, however, was not liked by a few Directors who thought that the World Bank was pressurizing the Board. However, Sir Ramaswami Mudaliar, who was then Chairman, appreciated the need for a change, as did G.D. Birla and Kasturbhai Lalbhai. Mudaliar proposed Mehta's name for the Chairman, both at the Board meeting and at the meeting of the shareholders. Mehta had known Mudaliar since the early 1940s and enjoyed his goodwill and confidence.

On September 8, 1958, George Woods sent Mehta a cable that the shareholders in the UK, the US, and the World Bank had all agreed that he should be the Chairman of ICICI. Mudaliar met two members of the Board, G.D. Birla and A.D. Shroff and informed George Woods, J. Burke Knapp, and Rucinski of the World Bank that some changes were being made in the Board of ICICI. Sir Badridas Goenka was to resign to make way for Mehta, and Mudaliar was to step down as the Chairman with Mehta taking his place. Mehta joined ICICI in October 1958 and his appointment as Chairman was approved by shareholders at a special meeting on December 1, 1958. Some other changes in the Board were made and young people were brought in. Mehta was instrumental in persuading Nani Palkhivala to join the Board despite his heavy pre-occupations and give ICICI the benefit of his legal knowledge and experience. Parekh and Palkhivala had great respect for each other. Palkhivala recalled how Parekh had presided over his